

Civil Rights Aide Silent on Red Question

By The Associated Press

The executive secretary of the Civil Rights Congress yesterday failed to produce records demanded by the House Lobby Investigating Committee.

And the witness, William L. Patterson of New York, refused to tell the committee whether he is now or ever was a Communist.

When Chairman Buchanan (D., Pa.) put the Communist question, Patterson replied:

"I refuse to answer that question. It violates my constitutional rights."

Among the data Patterson failed to produce in response to a committee subpoena were: Records of meetings of the board of directors, a list of officers, a membership list, and all reports by officers, agents and representatives during the last three years. Patterson said most of this information was not available.

The committee counsel, Benedict F. Fitzgerald, still was asking Patterson what he had and had not brought along when the committee told the witness to return this morning.

The Civil Rights Congress, listed as subversive by the Attorney General, has not registered under the Lobby Act since 1948. The reason, Patterson told the committee, is that its "main aim and purpose" is not lobbying but fighting "to maintain the constitutional liberties, the civil and human rights of the American people inviolate."